

UCLA TO PURSUE TALKS FOR U.S. FUNDING

School official is ‘very hopeful’ for a solution to lift grant freezes totaling \$339 million.

By JAWEED KALEEM

Since federal agencies surprised UCLA by freezing roughly \$339 million in research grants, faculty, graduate workers and students have sought out details on what the university — the first public higher education institution targeted by President Trump — will do.

Will UCLA challenge the federal government in court, negotiate and potentially pay a large fine or tap into emergency reserves to support researchers? With more than a third of its federal grant and contract funds frozen, will UCLA be forced to lay off employees, as Columbia, Harvard and other elite private universities did?

As Trump battles to remake colleges, the administration has accused UCLA of illegally allowing antisemitism, using race in admissions and letting transgender players compete on sports teams that match their gender identity. Ivy League schools have similarly been faulted by the administration over their responses to pro-Palestinian encampments last year.

Senior administrators outlined answers during a virtual town hall attended by about 3,000 faculty members Monday and also at department-level meetings, including at the UCLA Medical School, which has lost hundreds of grants from the National Institutes of Health.

But they cautioned that there were no final decisions.

“There is a time period to resolve the questions the government has for us,” Marcia L. Smith, associate vice chancellor for UCLA research administration, said during the virtual town hall. Smith said the leaders were “preparing” to contact the NIH, National Science Foundation and the Department of Energy — which froze roughly 800 grants over several days last week — “to

[See UCLA, A11]

Sierra Madre sees a surge in home break-ins by bears

City officials report 41 incidents just in June. Some blame the Eaton fire’s aftermath.

By LILA SEIDMAN

Police and wildlife officials were bombarded for weeks with reports of bears barging into homes in Sierra Madre, smashing windows and slashing screen doors.

So the California Department of Fish and Wildlife decided to kill the 300-pound female bear believed to be the culprit. State biologists set up a trap and the bear soon lumbered into it.

The bear was tranquilized and later shot and killed last month after wildlife personnel confirmed they had the right bear — a call based on a distinctive patch of fur on her back.

Break-ins dropped off after the bear was put down, but Sierra Madre officials say their ursine troubles are far from resolved.

Sierra Madre, Claremont, Monrovia and other communities nestled just below the San Gabriel



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

A FAMILY from Seattle visits Venice Skatepark on a warm Tuesday. The heat wave may peak Thursday.

California, brace for heat wave

A widespread and prolonged increase in temperatures is expected to elevate wildfire risk across the state over the next few days

By GRACE TOOHEY

Authorities in California are bracing themselves for a prolonged heat wave this week that could amplify the risks of a wildfire and intensify fires already burning in the southern and central portions of the state.

The warming trend is forecast to bake almost all of inland California over the next week, dialing up the heat on what’s already been a fiery summer in the state’s southern half, and raising the risks up north after a relatively quiet start to the season.

“This week will definitely bring

those elevated fire weather conditions,” said Adam Roser, a meteorologist at the National Weather Service in San Diego. In Southern California, “the vegetation is still very dry. ... [and] these are definitely some of the hotter temperatures we’ve seen so far this summer.”

Southern California’s hottest days are expected to be Wednesday through Friday, when much of the interior is under heat advisories as temperatures are forecast to range from the upper 90s to the triple digits across many valleys and deserts. Palm Springs could reach up to 118 on Thursday while downtown Los Angeles

could hit 90.

Weather service officials warn that there will be an increased risk for heat sickness and fires to start and grow out of control.

Already, much of inland Southern California is under a wildfire smoke advisory from three large fires burning in the region: the Gifford fire in Santa Barbara and San Luis Obispo counties — now California’s largest blaze of the year at 82,000 acres; the Rosa fire in Riverside County; and the Gold fire in San Bernardino County.

Inland Northern California will [See Heat, A14]

Dormant deportation cases are revived

Caught off guard, lawyers and migrants scramble as officials revisit years-old files.

By MELISSA GOMEZ, DAKOTA SMITH AND RACHEL URANGA

A decade ago, Jesus Adan Rico breathed a big sigh of relief. That was when the Chino High School student, a Dreamer, learned an immigration judge had in effect shelved his deportation proceedings.

Maria Torres, who came to the U.S. at 2 years old, also had her deportation proceedings paused by an immi-



MICHAEL M. SANTIAGO Getty Images

AGENTS patrol an immigration court in New York. The U.S. is reopening a flurry of deportation cases.

gration judge because she recently married a U.S. citizen.

Yet just eight weeks ago, Adan Rico — now 29, married with a new child — discovered that the Trump administration had revived his deportation case, even though he has renewed his DACA status at least four times. Torres learned the government wants to bring back her case just as she was preparing for her green card interview.

“No matter what we do, no matter how far we go in school, in our jobs and with our families, it doesn’t matter. It is all hanging by a thread,” he said.

Adan Rico and Torres are [See Cases, A7]



MANU FERNANDEZ Associated Press

SON HEUNG-MIN, a captain with Tottenham and holding the Europa League championship trophy, reportedly signed with LAFC for a \$26-million transfer fee.

Arrival of soccer star a huge draw for Korean community

By KEVIN BAXTER

LAFC’s signing of South Korean national team captain Son Heung-min appears to be one of those rare acquisitions that checks every box and helps everybody. Not only is it one of the most significant signings in MLS history, but it instantly makes LAFC better while boosting the World Cup hopes of the Korean national team and the profile of Kore-

an soccer in the U.S.

But in few places will the influence of the signing, which is expected to be completed Tuesday, be felt more directly than in Southern California’s Korean community, the largest in the U.S.

“The Korean community has been buzzing ever since rumors of Son Heung-min’s potential move to LAFC began to spread,” said Kyeongjun Kim, a writer with the Korean Daily, the largest Korean-language

media outlet in the U.S. “The fact that a player of his caliber is coming to L.A. is monumental event.”

“Son’s move to the LAFC is as exciting — if not more so — than when Chan Ho Park and Hyun-Jin Ryu joined the Dodgers.”

Luring Son, 33, away from Tottenham of the English Premier League, where he spent the past 10 seasons, came at a high price. Although financial details of [See Son, A8]

Trump to lead planning for L.A. Games

As task force chair, he may deploy troops to keep 2028 Olympics safe, president says.

By MICHAEL WILNER, JULIA WICK AND THUC NHI NGUYEN

WASHINGTON — In past Olympic Games held on American soil, sitting presidents have served in passive, ceremonial roles. President Trump may have other plans.

An executive order signed by Trump on Tuesday names him chair of a White House task force on the 2028 Games in Los Angeles, viewed by the president as “a premier opportunity to showcase American exceptionalism,” according to a White House statement. Trump, the administration said, “is taking every opportunity to showcase American greatness on the world stage.”

At the White House, speaking in front of banners adding the presidential seal to the logo for LA28, Trump said he would send the military back to Los Angeles if he so chose in order to protect the Games. In June, Trump sent the National Guard and U.S. Marines to the city amid widespread immigration enforcement actions, despite condemnation from Mayor Karen Bass and other local officials.

“We’ll do anything necessary to keep the Olympics safe, including using our National Guard or military, OK?” he said. “I will use the National Guard or the military. This is going to be so safe. If we have to.”

Trump’s executive order establishes a task force led by him and Vice President JD Vance to steer federal coordination for the Games. The task force will work with federal, state and local partners on security and transportation, according to the White House.

Those roles have been fairly standard for the federal government in past U.S.-hosted Olympic Games. But Trump’s news conference could present questions about whether a president with a penchant for showmanship might assume an unusually active role in planning the Olympics, set to take place in the twilight of his final term.

There is ample precedent for military and National Guard forces providing se-

[See Olympics, A7]

Panel subpoenas for Epstein files

A House committee orders Justice Department to turn over info from sex-trafficking inquiry. **NATION, A6**

County left off ‘sanctuary’ list

City of L.A., though, remains a Justice Department target over its support of immigrants. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Dreamy days for K-pop fanatics

At KCON, they meet, shop — and some get a chance to dance with their musical idols. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Sunny and warm. L.A. Basin: 90/67. **B6**

Markets A11 Opinion Voices A12

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

